Instant Pot French Onion Soup

Soups | Instant Pot

Before you start

Equipment: Instant Pot and oven-safe serving bowls. Onion pressure cook: 20 minutes, then quick-release; caramelize 22-30 minutes. Soup pressure setting: 0 minutes, then natural-release 20 minutes. Oven: 450°F; finish 6-8 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Soup aromatics and sauces

Bowl B - Stocks

- [ ] 4 lb onions (mostly yellow onions plus shallots), sliced; reserve about 1/2 lb for later
- [ ] 6 Tbsp unsalted butter
- [ ] 1/2 tsp baking soda
- [ ] 1/4 cup dry white wine
- [ ] 3 garlic cloves, minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp soy sauce [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tbsp fish sauce (or additional soy sauce) [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 bay leaf [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3 sprigs fresh thyme or 1 tsp dried thyme [Bowl A]
- [ ] 4 cups unsalted beef stock [Bowl B]
- [ ] 4 cups unsalted chicken stock [Bowl B]
- [ ] Kosher salt to taste
- [ ] French baguette, sliced 3/4-1 inch thick
- [ ] 4 oz grated Gruyère

1. Cook and caramelize onions

1. From 4 lb sliced onions (mostly yellow onions plus shallots), reserve about 1/2 lb for later.

2. On Sauté More, melt 6 Tbsp unsalted butter. Add the shallots and remaining yellow onions (about 3 1/2 lb total). Stir in 1/2 tsp baking soda, not baking powder, and sauté about 5 minutes.

3. Pressure-cook onions on high for 20 minutes, then quick-release.

4. Reserve the released onion liquid separately. Sauté the onions about 22-30 minutes, until deeply golden and caramelized.

2. Build the soup

1. Add 1/4 cup dry white wine and thoroughly scrape the bottom to loosen stuck bits.

2. Add 3 minced garlic cloves, 1 Tbsp soy sauce, 1 Tbsp fish sauce (or additional soy sauce), 1 bay leaf, 3 fresh thyme sprigs (or 1 tsp dried thyme), the reserved 1/2 lb onions, and reserved onion liquid.

3. Add 4 cups unsalted beef stock and 4 cups unsalted chicken stock. Set high pressure to 0 minutes. Let pressure release naturally 20 minutes, then release the remainder.

3. Add bread and cheese

1. Heat the oven to 450°F. Season soup with kosher salt to taste. For more body, simmer on sauté 5-10 minutes.

2. Ladle into oven-safe bowls. Top with French baguette slices, 3/4-1 inch thick, and divide 4 oz grated Gruyère among the bowls.

3. Bake 6-8 minutes, until cheese is melted and browned.

Notes

Use baking soda, not baking powder.

The soup freezes well without the bread topping.